

Department of Veterans Affairs

Memorandum

Date: March 11, 2026

From: Ronald Kendall, PharmD and Elizabeth Scruggs-Wodkowski, MD (Antimicrobial Stewardship Program Champions)

Subj: Restricted Antibiotics

To: All Providers, Residents, Pharmacists

Restricting the use of certain antimicrobials by requiring prior authorization from an Infectious Diseases specialist is a core strategy for hospital antimicrobial stewardship programs. The approval process requires clear and consistent communication and documentation in order to be successful and not delay care. This process has been successfully in place for decades at the Ann Arbor VA and this memorandum serves as a refresher on our expectations and processes.

Restricted antibiotics ordered in the inpatient, emergency, and all outpatient settings must be approved prior to the 1st dose, 24 hours a day, 7 days a week (including holidays). ID attendings, ID fellows, and the ID pharmacist are authorized to approve the use of restricted antibiotics. The ID fellow and ID pharmacist are on-call 24/7 to approve restricted antibiotics. The ID fellow can be reached at pager 3010 or office phone 734-845-5806. The ID pharmacist can be reached at office phone 734-845-5829 or by Microsoft Teams message. Dr. Scruggs-Wodkowski can be reached at office phone 734-222-6026 or by Microsoft Team message. The pharmacist will verify, prepare, and dispense an order for a restricted antibiotic only when the statement “Approved by [name of the approving provider]” appears in the order comments. If an order does not contain this information, the order will be flagged and not verified by a pharmacist.

Additionally, there is a significant number of antimicrobials which are non-formulary. ID approval is required for these in addition to approval via the non-formulary medication consult. Some antibiotics have national “Criteria for Use” created by the VA Pharmacy Benefits Management Services, Medical Advisory Panel, and VISN Pharmacist Executives. These antibiotics have “CFU” next to their name. The pharmacist should ensure all CFU are met prior to order verification. Use for individual cases which are believed to be appropriate exceptions to the CFU should be adjudicated for approval by the ID pharmacist and medical chief of Infectious Diseases. Please see chart on the next paged regarding the current classification of each antibiotic (HIV, hepatitis, otic, and ophthalmic medications, and vaccines not included).

Formulary, not restricted*	Formulary, restricted to ID (exceptions)	Non-formulary and restricted to ID
acyclovir (po)	acyclovir (IV) (Empiric use for 72 hours allowed without ID approval. Use beyond 72 hours requires ID approval unless there is a culture/PCR-confirmed pathogen which justifies continuation.)	abametapir
amoxicillin	albendazole	anidulafungin
amoxicillin/clavulanate	amikacin (x1 dose allowed without ID approval)	artesunate
amphotericin B (non-liposomal)	amikacin liposome inhaled soln (Arikayce) (CFU)	aztreonam for inhalation (Cayston)
ampicillin	amoxicillin/omeprazole/rifabutin (Talcia) (CFU)	aztreonam/avibactam
ampicillin/sulbactam	amoxicillin/vonoprazan (Voquenza DualPak(CFU)	bedaquilline
atovaquone/proguanil (malarone)	amphotericin B liposomal	berdazimer
azithromycin (all forms except 600 mg tablet)	atovaquone	casprofungin
bismuth subsalicylate	aztreonam IV	cefepime/enmetazobactam
cefazolin	baloxavir marboxil	ceftobiprole
cefoxitin	cefdinir	chloroquine
ceftriaxone	cefepime (Empiric use of cefepime/zosyn for 72 hours allowed without ID approval. Use beyond 72 hours requires ID approval unless there is a culture-confirmed pathogen which justifies continuation.)	colistimethate
cefuroxime	cefiderocol	crotamiton
cephalexin	cefixime	dalbavancin
chloroquine	cefpodoxime	delafloxacin
ciclopirox	ceftaroline	econazole
clarithromycin	ceftazidime (nephrology allowed to use intraperitoneal)	efinaconazole
clotrimazole troche	ceftazidime/avibactam	fexinidazole
dapsone	ceftolozane/tazobactam	gepotedican
dicloxacillin	chloramphenicol	ibrexafungerp (CFU)
doxycycline	cidofovir	isavuconazole
erythromycin	ciprofloxacin (urology allowed 4 weeks for acute prostatitis if trim/sulfa cannot be used)	malathion
ethambutol	clindamycin	maribavir
famciclovir	daptomycin	medihoney
hydroxychloroquine	eravacycline	mefloquine
isoniazid	ertapenem	minocycline (IV)
methenamine hippurate	fecal microbiota, live (Rebyota, Vowst) (CFU)	nitazoxanide
metronidazole	fidaxomicin (CFU)	omadacycline
miconazole nitrate 2% powder and cream	fluconazole (up to 3 doses of 200 mg tablets allowed for vulvovaginal candidiasis without approval and heme/onc and rad/onc allowed to use for prophylaxis)	oritavancin
minocycline (po)	flucytosine	oteseconazole (CFU)
molnupiravir (EUA reqs)	foscarnet	paromomycin
mupirocin	fosfomycin (CFU)	peramavir
neomycin	ganciclovir	pivmecillinam
nirmaltrevir/ritonavir	gentamicin (x1 dose and surgical prophylaxis use allowed without ID approval and urology may use for bladder irrigation)	plazomicin
nitrofurantoin	imipenem/cilastatin	pretomanid
nystatin suspension	imipenem/cilastatin/relebactam	rifaximin (CFU)
oseltamivir	itraconazole	sarecycline
penicillin benzathine (IM)	ivermectin (CFU)	Sulopenem/probenecid
penicillin G, K (IV)	Ketoconazole tab (endocrine allowed to use for Cushing's and oncology allowed to use for malignancy)	tedizolid
penicillin VK (po)	lefamulin (CFU)	telavancin
permethrin	letermovir (CFU)	tinidazole
primaquine phosphate	levofloxacin	tobramycin (TOBI neb)
pyrantel pamoate (OTC for Pinworm)	linezolid	vonaprazan/amoxicillin/clarithromycin (Voquenza) (CFU)
pyrazinamide	meropenem	zofludacin
pyrimethamine	meropenem/vaborbactam	
remdesivir	micafungin	
rifabutin	moxifloxacin	
rifampin (PO)	nafcillin	
rifapentine	pentamidine (IV and nebulized)	
silver sulfadiazene 1% cream	piperacillin/tazobactam (Empiric use of cefepime/zosyn for 72 hours allowed without ID approval. Use beyond 72 hours requires ID approval unless there is a culture-confirmed pathogen which justifies continuation.)	
terbinafine	polymyxin B	
tetracycline	posaconazole (heme/onc allowed to use for prophylaxis)	
trimethoprim	rezafungin	
trimethoprim/sulfamethoxazole (PO)	rifampin (IV)	
valacyclovir	secnidazole (women's health allowed to use)	
vancomycin (IV, PO)	streptomycin	
	sulbactam/durlobactam	
	tigecycline	
	tobramycin (x1 dose allowed without ID approval)	
	Trimethoprim/sulfamethoxazole (IV)	
	valganciclovir (nephrology allowed to use for prophylaxis)	
	voriconazole (heme/onc allowed to use for prophylaxis)	
	zanamivir	

*Not all dosage forms of formulary agents are considered available for use and may be considered not formulary (e.g. ciprofloxacin oral suspension, acyclovir ointment, azithromycin 600 mg tablet). Check with pharmacy for availability and approval.

**Some agents on the VA National Formulary not listed above due to local preferences: cefadroxil, cefaclor, cefotaxime, doripenem, ketoconazole, oxacillin